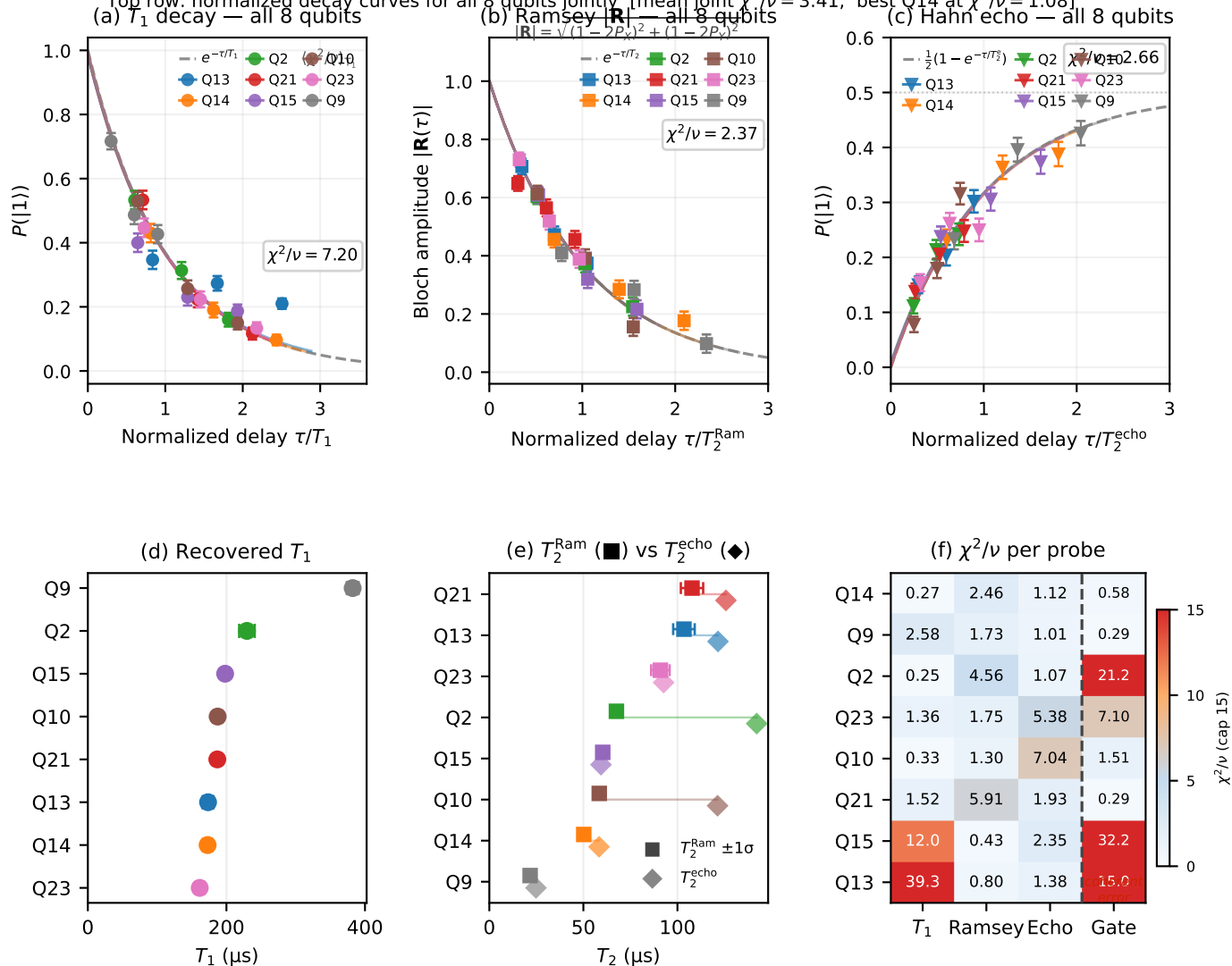


Fig.~5 — IBM Heron r2 Hardware Validation (ibm_fez, $N_q = 8, 9, 900$ shots/qubit, per-qubit delay scheduling)

Top row: normalized decay curves for all 8 qubits jointly [mean joint $\chi^2/\nu = 3.41$, best Q14 at $\chi^2/\nu = 1.08$]



Top row: data collapsed onto normalized time axis — all qubits should follow the reference curve (dashed) if the model is correct. Curves: Canary forward model at recovered $\hat{\theta}$.